

Toliver_peer_review2

Part III: Applying Feedback

Content & Audience

Did peers understand the purpose of your product and what problem it solves?

Yes, my peers definitely got what Key Away is all about. They understood that it's designed to solve the frustrating problem of spending way too much time scrolling through streaming services without finding anything to watch. A couple people mentioned they related to the "30 minutes of scrolling" example I used on the landing page, which made me feel like the concept really hit home for them. They saw how using keywords instead of traditional categories could make finding movies faster and more personalized.

Did they clearly understand who the site is for?

For the most part, yes. My peers understood that Key Away is meant for anyone who watches streaming content and gets tired of endless browsing. One person mentioned it would be especially useful for people who are indecisive or have specific moods they want to match. However, I realized from their feedback that I could make the target audience even clearer - maybe adding something about busy people or film enthusiasts who know exactly what vibe they're looking for. The site is really meant for everyone who streams content, so I want to make sure that comes across better.

Design

What feedback did peers give about your planning and design elements?

Overall, the feedback on my design was really positive. People liked the dark cinematic theme I chose - they said it felt appropriate for a movie discovery platform and looked professional. They appreciated the purple-blue gradient I used for buttons and accents, saying it made the site feel modern and cohesive. The moving background on the landing page got some positive comments too, though one person said it was a bit distracting at first.

My peers also mentioned they liked how I organized the search results page with the movie cards in a grid layout. They thought the review page was well structured with the stats at the top and

individual review cards below. The overall consensus was that the design felt intentional and put-together.

Did they find your structure, navigation and visual layout effective?

Yes, they found the navigation clear and easy to use. The links at the bottom of each page made it simple to move between the home page, search example, and reviews. A few people suggested adding the navigation to the top of the page as well for easier access, which is something I might consider.

The visual layout worked well for most people. They liked how information was broken up into sections and how the movie cards made browsing results feel organized. One thing that came up multiple times was the image sizing - some of the posters and background images didn't always fit perfectly on different screen sizes, which affected the overall look on mobile devices.

Development

What feedback did peers give about your site's code-driven features or interactivity?

My peers appreciated the form on the search results page and how it lets users refine their search with different filters. They liked the interactive elements like the hover effects on the movie cards and links. The submit button's animation when you hover over it got some positive comments.

However, since we haven't fully implemented JavaScript functionality yet, they noted that the form doesn't actually do anything when you submit it, which is expected at this stage. They understood this is something that would be added later but mentioned it would be cool to see the search actually work with the keywords.

Did they identify any issues with responsiveness, layout or broken behavior?

This was the biggest piece of feedback I got. Several peers mentioned that some images didn't resize properly on smaller screens. Specifically, the movie posters on the reviews page were sometimes cut off or stretched weird on mobile. The background image on the landing page also had some issues at certain screen widths.

The table on the search results page worked okay on desktop but got a bit cramped on mobile screens. Some people suggested I could make it scroll horizontally or stack the information

differently for smaller devices. Other than the image sizing issues, the layout generally held up well across different screen sizes.

What accessibility feedback did you receive?

I got good feedback on accessibility. My peers noticed I included alt text on all the images, which they appreciated. They also saw the skip navigation link I added for keyboard users, though some weren't sure what it did until I explained it. The color contrast between the dark background and light text was good according to their feedback - everything was easy to read.

One suggestion was to make sure all the interactive elements are clearly marked and easy to tab through with a keyboard. I have focus states on links and buttons, but they recommended testing the whole site with just keyboard navigation to make sure nothing gets missed.

Overall Site

How did visitors rate the overall appearance and usability of your site?

The overall ratings were pretty positive. Most people said the site looked professional and they could tell I put effort into making it look polished. They liked the consistent styling across all three pages and thought the color scheme worked well. The usability was good - people could figure out where to go and what to click without any confusion.

On a scale that came up in discussion, most people would rate it somewhere between 7-9 out of 10, with the main points deducted for the image sizing issues and the fact that some features aren't fully functional yet. Overall though, they seemed impressed with how it turned out.

What did peers identify as the strongest part of your website, and why do you think that aspect stood out?

The strongest part according to my peers was definitely the overall concept and visual design. They really liked the idea of keyword-based movie searching - several people said they wished this actually existed because they'd use it. I think this stood out because it addresses a real problem that everyone who uses streaming services can relate to.

The design also got a lot of praise. People appreciated that it looked cohesive and professional, with the dark theme and purple gradients making it feel modern and cinema-related. The review cards on the reviews page were specifically mentioned as looking really nice and well-organized. I think the design stood out because it felt complete and intentional rather than thrown together.

What improvements did they recommend?

The main improvement everyone mentioned was fixing the image sizing issues. They wanted the posters and background images to scale better on different devices so nothing looks stretched or cut off. A few people also suggested making the site more interactive - adding features like clicking on a movie card to see more details or actually having the search form work.

Some other recommendations included adding more content to the pages, like additional movie recommendations or more detailed reviews. One person suggested adding a "featured picks" section on the home page. Another mentioned it would be cool to have filter options that actually update the displayed movies in real-time.

Action Plan

What two improvements will you make based on their feedback, and how will you implement them?

1. Fix Image Sizing and Responsiveness

This was by far the most consistent feedback I received. I'm going to go through all my images and make sure they're properly sized and responsive. For the movie posters on the review cards, I'll use object-fit: cover in CSS to make sure they fill their containers without getting distorted. For the background images, I'll test them at different screen sizes and adjust the background-size and background-position properties to make sure they look good everywhere. I'll also add more media queries to handle the table on mobile devices better - probably making it scroll horizontally or reorganizing how the information displays on small screens.

2. Enhance Navigation and User Flow

Several peers suggested making navigation more accessible by adding links to the top of each page in addition to the bottom. I'm going to create a proper navigation bar in the header section that stays consistent across all pages. This will make it easier for users to move around the site without scrolling all the way down. I'll also make sure the navigation is fully responsive and works well on mobile devices - maybe turning it into a hamburger menu on smaller screens.

Both of these improvements will make the site more professional and user-friendly. The image fixes will make everything look polished and intentional across all devices, while the improved navigation will make the site easier to use and more aligned with standard web design practices. I'm planning to tackle the image issues first since they affect the visual appearance the most, then move on to updating the navigation structure.